

Present Simple vs Present Continuous

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Both are present tenses, but they see time differently. Use:

- 1 Present simple for habits and facts — I work in Girona.
- 2 Present continuous for right now or temporary — I'm working from home today.
- 3 Present simple with stative verbs — I want a coffee (never 'I'm wanting').

Signal words help: every day / usually → present simple; now / at the moment / today → present continuous.

At a glance

	Present Simple	Present Continuous
Use	habits, facts, permanent things	now, temporary things, arrangements
Signal words	always, usually, every day, on Mondays	now, at the moment, today, this week
Example	She works in a bank.	She's working late today.
Stative verbs	yes — I know	no — I'm knowing

Learning objectives

- Can select the present simple or present continuous by function — habit/fact versus now/temporary (CEFR A2).
- Can identify stative verbs and avoid the continuous with them.
- Can use signal words to justify the tense choice.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Present Simple vs Present Continuous · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. She usually ____ to work, but today she ____ the bus.

A. is driving / takes

B. drives / is taking

C. drives / takes

D. is driving / is taking

2. Listen! Someone ____ upstairs.

A. sings

B. is singing

C. sing

D. sang

3. Water ____ at 100 degrees.

A. is boiling

B. boils

C. boil

D. boiled

4. Don't disturb her — she ____ for an exam this week.

A. studies

B. is studying

C. study

D. studied

5. I ____ what you mean. Can you explain again?

A. 'm not understanding

B. don't understand

C. am not understand

D. understanding

6. We ____ dinner at eight every evening.

A. are having

B. have

C. has

D. having

7. Look! The bus ____.

A. comes

B. is coming

C. come

D. came

8. He ____ in Berlin this month for a training course.

A. stays

B. is staying

C. stay

D. stayed

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'My usual routine is to go to the gym on Mondays.'

A. I'm going to the gym on Mondays.

B. I go to the gym on Mondays.

C. I went to the gym on Monday.

D. I'm at the gym right now.

10. The train to Madrid ____ at 6 o'clock every morning.

A. is leaving

B. leaves

C. leave

D. left

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. drives / is taking** — 'Usually drives' (habit) + 'today is taking' (this occasion) uses each tense correctly.
2. **B. is singing** — 'Listen!' signals an action in progress now: 'is singing'.
3. **B. boils** — General truths and facts take the present simple: 'Water boils at 100 degrees.'
4. **B. is studying** — A temporary situation around now ('this week') takes the present continuous: 'is studying'.
5. **B. don't understand** — State verbs like 'understand' use the present simple: 'I don't understand.'
6. **B. have** — A daily routine ('every evening') takes the present simple: 'have'.
7. **B. is coming** — 'Look!' signals something happening at this moment: 'is coming'.
8. **B. is staying** — A temporary situation ('this month') takes the present continuous: 'is staying'.
9. **B. I go to the gym on Mondays.** — A routine takes the present simple: 'I go to the gym on Mondays.'
10. **B. leaves** — Timetables use the present simple: 'The train leaves at 6 every morning.'